

PROJECT SIGHTLINE.

A live test of everything you claim to know.

*Vibe coding is not magic. It is leverage.
Leverage in the wrong hands builds nothing.
This brief is your proof of work.*

ISSUED TO

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Student. Vibe coding cohort.

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ISSUED BY

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DATE

16 MAY 2026

REFERENCE

HC-VC-2026-001

STATUS

ACTIVE

DEADLINE

23 MAY 2026

01 / THE MISSION

Build it. Ship it. Prove it works.

You have seven days. Not seven weekends. Not seven 'ish.' Seven calendar days from the moment this brief lands in your hands. At the end of those seven days a stranger on the internet should be able to open a public URL, use what you have built, and walk away with something useful.

The product is called SIGHTLINE. It is a deployed web application that accepts an image, by upload or by URL, and lets the user ask natural language questions about what is inside that image. The detection backbone is your choice. Grounding DINO. A VLM. Claude Vision. Gemini Vision. OpenAI Vision. The decision is part of the test.

This is not a tutorial. There is no walkthrough. No notebook to copy. No starter repo to fork. The point of vibe coding is that you, with the right tools and the right taste, can take an idea from a sentence to a live product in days. If that is true for you, prove it. If it is not, find out now, in the safest place possible, which is a brief from your own tutor.

WHAT YOUR GITHUB ALREADY TELLS ME

Dog breed classification with a deep net. A 2D Rocket League agent. xv6 in assembly. Space Invaders in C++. The intelligence is there. The shipping is not. Every repo on your account is coursework or a notebook. None of it runs on the open internet at a URL a stranger could find. Sightline fixes that gap. The model bit will be easy for you. The product bit is the test.

THE ONE LINE VERSION

A live web app. Upload an image. Ask a question. Get an answer powered by a vision model. Shipped, deployed, shareable. Seven days.

02 / SPECIFICATIONS

What good looks like.

These are the constraints. Constraints are a gift. They remove the decisions that do not matter so you can spend your energy on the ones that do.

FRONTEND

- Hosted on Vercel. Custom domain optional but encouraged.
- Mobile responsive. Test it on your actual phone, not a dev tools simulator.
- Loading states, error states, empty states. All three handled.
- One screen. No tabs. No menus. Upload. Ask. See answer.

BACKEND

- Inference endpoint of your choice. Hosted or hit via API.
- API keys handled server side. Never exposed to the browser.
- Typical response under five seconds. Slower than that, show progress.

AUTH AND STORAGE

- User sign in via email magic link or Google.
- Every query stored against the user account.
- A history view the user can scroll back through.

STACK

- TypeScript only. No JavaScript files. No exceptions.
- Next.js 14 or 15, app router.
- Tailwind for styling. No additional CSS frameworks.
- Supabase or Neon for the database. Pick one and justify it in the README.

OUT OF SCOPE

- Payments. Do not build them.
- An admin panel. Do not build one.
- A landing page. The product is the landing page.
- Anything Jupyter. This is not a notebook submission.

03 / EVALUATION

How you will be graded.

Five criteria. Each weighted equally. There is no extra credit for going beyond the brief. There is, however, severe penalty for missing the bits that are written down.

01 SHIP SPEED

Does it exist on a live URL inside seven days. Not on your laptop. Not on a staging branch. Live.

02 TASTE

Does the interface feel like something a person would willingly use, or does it feel like a coursework submission. Spacing, typography, contrast, motion. All of it counts.

03 ROBUSTNESS

What happens when the user uploads a 30 megabyte image. What happens when the API key fails. What happens when the prompt is empty. Every edge case you have not handled will be tested.

04 CODE QUALITY

Clean folder structure. Sensible component splits. No 800 line files. Commit messages that read like a human wrote them, not like a robot apologising.

05 JUDGEMENT

The bits of this brief that are deliberately vague. The model you picked. The auth provider you picked. The error copy you wrote. Every choice you made when nobody was watching.

INSTANT FAIL CONDITIONS

- The URL does not load when opened from a phone on a different network.
- The API key is visible in the browser network tab.
- The README was written before a single feature shipped.
- Any file in the repository contains the words 'TODO: refactor this later.'

04 / GROUND RULES

The rules of the game.

- 01 Use every AI tool you can get your hands on. Claude, Cursor, Antigravity, anything. Vibe coding is the point.
- 02 Do not clone a live deployed product. Inspiration is fine. Copy paste is not.
- 03 Commit to your existing GitHub. Full history. No squashing the messy parts out at the end.
- 04 Deploy as you go. By day two there must be a live URL that does at least one thing well.
- 05 Write the README last. Ship first, narrate second.

DELIVERABLES

- A live URL. Anyone with the link must be able to use it.
- A public GitHub repository link.
- A 90 second screen recording of you using the product end to end.
- One paragraph on what you would change with another week.

SUBMIT TO ZAIB KHAN VIA WHATSAPP. DEADLINE 23 MAY 2026, 23:59 BST.

After the deadline, late work is graded but capped at fifty per cent.

ONE FINAL WORD

You have been chosen for this brief because your tutor believes you can clear it. Treat that belief carefully. It is worth more than the grade at the end.

SIGNED

Zaib Khan

ZAIB KHAN

Co-founder, HandCode.org

Tutor of record. Vibe coding.

BRIEF STATUS

ISSUED.

REF HC-VC-2026-001

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